



SQL ENGINEERING HANDBOOK

Awesome Tools

Editors, clients, ERD tools, and formatters

Awesome Tools

Part of the [Resources Library](#) — [SQL Engineering Handbook](#)

Editors, clients, ERD tools, and formatters — the software around the SQL, not the SQL itself.

Tool	Category	What It's For	Free / Paid
DBeaver	Database Client	Free, universal database client supporting nearly every SQL dialect — a solid single default if you don't already have a preference	Free (Community Edition); paid Enterprise tier
TablePlus	Database Client	Fast, clean native client, popular on macOS specifically, with a genuinely pleasant query and table-editing UI	Free tier (limited); paid for full use
DataGrip	Database IDE	JetBrains' full SQL IDE — refactoring, smart code completion, and version control integration for serious schema work	Paid (free for students/OSS via JetBrains' education program)
dbdiagram.io	ERD Tool	Text-to-diagram ERD tool — describe a schema in a simple DSL and get a clean visual diagram out	Free tier; paid for private diagrams
DrawSQL	ERD Tool	Visual, drag-and-drop ERD builder with schema export	Free tier; paid for team features
pgAdmin	Database Client	The official PostgreSQL administration and development client	Free
SQLFluff	Formatter / Linter	A configurable SQL linter and auto-formatter supporting multiple dialects — useful for keeping this repo's own query style consistent	Free, open source

[!TIP] Pick one primary client and learn its keyboard shortcuts properly rather than switching between three. The tool matters far less than fluency with whichever one you pick.

This closes the full *Resources Library* — all 13 files are now in place. Back to [Resources Library](#).